

BLACK DRAGONS INITIATIVE -- FOUNDING DOCUMENT

Declaration of Self-Determination of the BLACK Dragons

Revised Edition -- 2026-09-11

PUBLISHED 2026-09-11 -- E5 ENCLAVE INC.

PROVENANCE & PUBLICATION NOTE

Provenance & publication note

E5 Enclave Inc. is a nonpartisan 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization. This founding document is preserved as written; two provisions directing electoral candidate activity have been struck in this edition with visible markers and dated notes, per the Chairman's ratified amendment A2 to War Room 3 (2026-09-11), and are parked for the affiliated 501(c)(4) sibling upon completion of its registration.

E5 Enclave Inc. does not endorse unlawful conduct. Retained exempt-organizations tax counsel is reviewing this edition.

REVISION NOTE - what changed and why

Authority: Chairman's ratified amendments to War Room 3 (2026-09-11), amendment A2 - campaign intervention is absolutely prohibited for 501(c)(3)s (IRC §501(c)(3); Rev. Rul. 2007-41), so electoral candidate provisions move to the future affiliated 501(c)(4).

D1. In "2. Political Mobilization and Self-Governance": the clause *"and run our own candidates - nurturing a new generation of Black leaders who serve the people, not entrenched interests"* is struck; *"We will hold officials accountable"* is retained.

D2. In "Calls to Action - Build Political Power in Our Communities": the sentence *"Run for office or support candidates who are accountable to the Black community."* is struck; the remainder of the bullet (assemblies, voter drives, advocacy groups, voter-suppression work, lobbying for policies, presence at school boards/councils/legislatures) is retained.

Struck provisions are shown in the text with strikethrough and dated margin notes - original wording preserved for provenance, never silently deleted.

Preamble

We, the BLACK Dragons, descendants of a displaced and resilient people, stand at the crossroads of history with the wisdom of our ancestors at our backs and the vision of liberation in our sights. For centuries, we have endured the Middle Passage and the auction block, the plantation whip and the prison cell, Jim Crow segregation and systemic oppression. Yet through it all, we have kept our eyes on the North Star - following the path of escape and resistance blazed by those before us. Like a modern Exodus, we are a people guided by the hope of a promised land of freedom, each generation carrying forward the torch of justice. We have come this far by faith and by fight, and we declare that we will not turn back.

In the spirit of uncompromising demand for dignity, we affirm our humanity and our right to exist in fullness. As Malcolm X proclaimed, "We declare our right on this earth... to be a human being, to be respected as a human being, to be given the rights of a human being in this society... by any means necessary." Our declaration is born from the same insistence on respect and self-worth. We invoke the righteous anger of the prophets of our struggle - the self-defense of Malcolm, the unifying passion of Fred Hampton, the revolutionary vision of Huey P. Newton, the literary fire of Toni Morrison, the scholarly insight of W.E.B. Du Bois, and the moral fervor of Cornel West. We honor the known and unnamed freedom fighters, from Harriet Tubman and Marcus Garvey to the foot soldiers of civil rights, who built an Underground Railroad to deliver us from bondage. Now, in their honor, we consecrate an Aboveground Railroad of Self-Determination - an open, overground network for liberation, empowerment, and progress for all Black people.

Grounded in the lessons of history and the nourishment of ancestral spirit, we present this manifesto as a covenant with our people. It is a foundational credo and a clarion call. With the Akan wisdom of Sankofa - looking back to fetch what is useful as we march forward - we fuse the rich echoes of past revolutions with the urgent voice of today. We declare our sovereignty in the 21st century, affirming that our destiny will be determined by us alone. They have tried to chain us, silence us, and even kill us, but they cannot destroy our revolution. As martyred revolutionary Fred Hampton defiantly said, "You can kill a revolutionary but you can never kill the revolution." This living revolution now takes form in the BLACK Dragons, rising like a phoenix from the ashes of oppression, guided by love for our people and an unyielding demand for freedom now.

Guiding Principles

In pursuit of our liberation, we uphold these core principles as the pillars of our movement - our BIG5 focus: Black Power, Political Mobilization, Economic Independence, Cultural Renaissance, and Race-First Solidarity. These principles will light our path as we build an aboveground railroad to carry our people to true freedom.

1. Black Power and Sovereignty

We claim the full measure of Black Power as a force for our self-determination and self-governance. Black Power means that we, as Black people, take back the agency to shape our own destiny. In the words of Huey P. Newton, "Black Power is giving power to people who have not had power to determine their destiny." We do not seek power to dominate others; we seek power over ourselves - the power to define, the power to create, and the power to rule our communities with justice. After centuries of being subjected to the dehumanizing forces of exploitation and racism, we assert our right to control our own institutions, land, and resources. As Huey P. Newton explained, what we seek is not power over people, but "the power to control our own destiny." This is sovereignty: the inalienable right for our communities to decide our own course in every sphere of life.

Black Power and sovereignty mean we no longer beg for inclusion on terms set by others, but stand up as equals - as authors of our own narrative. We reclaim the names, languages, and identities that were stolen or suppressed, recognizing that defining ourselves is the first act of liberation. No law, no government, and no social system has legitimacy unless it arises from the will of the people. Thus, we will build the capacity to govern ourselves - from family units and neighborhoods to cities and beyond. We will practice community self-defense and conflict resolution, ensuring that our people are protected and our streets are safe without reliance on oppressive forces. In claiming Black Power, we embrace the mantra "All Power to the People!", understanding that an empowered Black nation within a nation is a cornerstone of true democracy. We hold deep faith that there is no obstacle that a determined people cannot overcome, for "there is in this world no such force as the force of a person determined to rise. The human soul cannot be permanently chained." Our resolve is unbreakable and our souls are free.

2. Political Mobilization and Self-Governance

We will harness our collective strength through political mobilization to achieve representation and policies that reflect our community's needs. Since the earliest days of Reconstruction, when newly emancipated Black people first held public office, we have understood that political power is essential to guard our freedoms. We continue that struggle in modern form, organizing at every level - local, regional, national, and global. The ballot is our weapon as much as protest is. We remember the words of Malcolm X warning that it's either "the ballot or the bullet" - a recognition that we must wield our votes with purpose, or others will continue to wield violence against us. Thus, we are committed to robust voter education, registration, and participation to ensure Black voices are heard in every election. We will hold officials accountable ~~and run our own candidates — nurturing a new generation of Black leaders who serve the people, not entrenched interests~~

Political self-determination also means building independent Black political institutions. We draw inspiration from the legacy of the Black Panther Party's Ten-Point Program demanding freedom, full employment, decent housing, education, and an end to police brutality. We carry forward that vision by forming grassroots councils, caucuses, and assemblies that speak to the needs of Black communities first. Through these organs of people's power, we practice self-governance - deliberating and deciding how to allocate resources, how to educate our children, and how to administer justice in our communities. We seek not just presence in the existing system, but transformation of the system itself. In solidarity with other oppressed peoples, we will build coalitions that advance justice for all, while keeping Black liberation as our spearhead. We will not rest until the halls of power echo with the truth of our experience and the urgency of our demands. Every policy, from city budgets to federal laws, must be evaluated by a single criterion: does it advance the freedom and well-being of Black people? If it does not, we will organize, agitate, and vote to change it. Our politics is not mere inclusion - it is revolutionary inclusion that restructures society. If our political voice is ignored, we reserve the right to take action by any means necessary to secure our rights. Liberty or death; freedom for everybody or freedom for nobody - this is the existential clarity that guides our political movement.

3. Economic Independence and Self-Sufficiency

We strive for economic independence as a bulwark of true freedom. After centuries of exploited labor - from chattel slavery to sharecropping, from redlined segregation to unequal wages - we understand that political freedom is incomplete without economic power. No community can be truly self-determining if it is economically dependent on those who oppress it. Therefore, we commit to building and supporting independent economic structures that allow wealth to circulate and grow within the Black community. This means prioritizing Black-owned businesses, banks, and farms, and creating cooperative enterprises that empower workers and consumers. Self-sufficiency is our goal: to feed, clothe, house, and employ our people through our own endeavors, reducing reliance on systems that have historically marginalized us.

We invoke the memory of Tulsa's "Black Wall Street" and countless other Black economic havens that thrived through ingenuity and unity, even under hostile conditions. Their destruction by racist violence taught us that prosperity without protection is fragile. Thus, our economic independence goes hand in hand with our collective security and political advocacy. We will establish community development funds, "Buy Black" campaigns, and solidarity economies that pool our resources for the common good. Every Black dollar is a bullet in our struggle for autonomy - we will aim those resources strategically to uplift our neighborhoods. We champion land ownership, housing cooperatives, and sustainable agriculture to ensure that our families have stability and our communities control the land beneath our feet. In the spirit of ujamaa (cooperative economics), each enterprise we build is not just for profit, but for people, serving the community and creating opportunity. Education in financial literacy, entrepreneurship, and trade skills will be spread wide, so that each household becomes a fortress of economic resilience. We declare that we shall no longer be the last hired and first fired. Instead, we will be owners, investors, and innovators, mastering every trade and industry from farming to finance, technology to the arts. Our economic liberation is the foundation on which our political and cultural liberation stands, forming a tripod of empowerment that cannot be easily toppled. When we control our economics, we control our destiny.

4. Cultural Renaissance and Self-Definition

We ignite a Cultural Renaissance to rehabilitate our collective spirit and celebrate the fullness of Black identity. For too long, our narrative has been distorted or told through lenses that were not our own. Now, we reclaim our story, our voice, and our image. This principle is about self-definition: the right to define who we are, on our own terms, and to have that definition respected. We draw strength from the Harlem Renaissance, the Black Arts Movement, and the creative genius that has always flowed from our community even in the harshest times. Our songs of sorrow and joy, from the spirituals sung on the plantation to the hip-hop anthems of today, carry the code of our survival and aspirations. We will foster a renaissance in education, art, and media that centers Black experiences and honors our African roots. This renaissance is not mere nostalgia - it is an alive and future-oriented culture of Black excellence in literature, science, philosophy, and every endeavor of the human spirit.

Our Cultural Renaissance stands on the shoulders of giants like Zora Neale Hurston, James Baldwin, Nina Simone, and Toni Morrison, who taught us the power of owning our story. As Toni Morrison wrote, "Freeing yourself was one thing, claiming ownership of that freed self was another." We heed this wisdom: it is not enough to shed the physical bonds of oppression; we must also seize our right to intellectual and creative freedom. Thus, we encourage all Black people to create - to write our books and journals, produce our films and theater, paint our truths on canvases and walls, and speak our unfiltered truth in classrooms and conferences. We will establish independent schools and cultural centers that teach our true history - from the kingdoms of Africa and the horrors of the transatlantic slave trade to the triumphs of civil rights and global independence movements. Our curricula will instill pride, not shame; confidence, not confusion. We embrace the principle of Sankofa, knowing that reaching back to learn from our past is the only way to move forward. We honor our ancestors' wisdom and also innovate for our descendants, blending tradition with fresh vision.

In this cultural rebirth, spirituality and faith play a unifying role as well. We recognize the rich tapestry of Black spirituality - Christian, Muslim, Yoruba, Vodun, Buddhist, and more - as sources of strength and identity. Our manifesto invokes spiritual metaphors like Exodus and the Underground Railroad not to impose one religion, but to connect to a shared heritage of hope and deliverance. We welcome all Black people of all faiths (or none) to find common inspiration in our story of overcoming. Through rituals, remembrance, and celebrations like Kwanzaa and Juneteenth, we nourish the soul of our movement. Our culture is our armor against assimilation and erasure. It is a wellspring of Black joy, radical imagination, and communal healing. By resurrecting and reinventing our cultural expressions, we resurrect our true selves. The BLACK Dragons pledge to be torchbearers in this renaissance, lighting the flame of knowledge and creativity in every Black heart, so that no child of ours grows up believing they are anything less than magnificent. We claim our freedom not only in body, but in mind and soul.

5. Race First Solidarity and Global Black Unity

We uphold Race First Solidarity as a guiding principle, affirming that all Black people are family across all divisions of nation, class, gender, or creed. Our struggle for liberation is global - from Harlem to Haiti, from Accra to Atlanta, from São Paulo to South Africa. We recognize that the oppression of Black people has been worldwide, through colonialism, imperialism, and white supremacy, and so our unity must also be worldwide. Our strength is in our oneness. As Malcolm X taught, no matter our different religions or affiliations, we face a common oppression that requires a common front: "Whether you are a Christian, or a Muslim, or a Nationalist, we all have the same problem... They don't attack me because I'm a Muslim; they attack me 'cause I'm Black... All of us catch hell from the same enemy." Therefore, we set aside minor differences in the name of major unity. We place Race First not out of hatred for others, but out of love for ourselves, knowing that only by uniting as one people can we overcome the forces arrayed against us.

Race First Solidarity means that an injury to one is an injury to all. When a Black life is lost to police brutality in the United States, or a Black migrant is mistreated abroad, or a Black village is plundered in Africa, we feel that pain collectively and we respond collectively. We commit to practicing cooperative economics and mutual aid not just locally, but across borders - supporting Black businesses, media, and initiatives around the globe. We look to the legacy of Pan-Africanism as championed by leaders like W.E.B. Du Bois and Kwame Nkrumah, who understood that the fate of African people globally is intertwined. In their spirit, we will forge links between the diaspora and the Motherland: educational exchanges, trade and investment, shared strategies in activism, and a common cultural embrace. We also recognize the diversity within our unity: we affirm the lives and leadership of Black women, whose contributions from Sojourner Truth to Angela Davis have been the backbone of our struggle; we affirm our LGBTQ+ Black family, historically present from the Harlem Renaissance to today's movement, as integral and deserving of love and respect; we affirm that every Black life matters. Our solidarity is inclusive and unbreakable.

By putting Race First, we do not mean "Race Only" - we extend hands of alliance to other oppressed communities and ethical allies. But we prioritize Black liberation as our movement's primary focus, unapologetically. We understand that true solidarity with others is only possible when we are solid in ourselves. United in purpose, the BLACK Dragons see ourselves as an Aboveground Railroad - a network of safe spaces, resources, and cooperation in plain sight, moving our people toward freedom station. Every Black church, mosque, or temple, every community center, every Pan-African student group, every enlightened workplace can be a station on this Railroad. It is "aboveground" because we are not hiding our mission; we are bringing it into the open, into the policy forums, onto the main streets, into the classrooms. Our solidarity will be our vehicle: each act of coming together, each coalition, each family we lift up is another mile traversed towards the promised land of self-determination. One people, one aim, one destiny - that is our creed. In love and unity, we shall overcome.

Calls to Action

Guided by the above principles, we issue a clarion call to action. The BLACK Dragons declare that now is the time for action on every front of our struggle. We invite all who read this manifesto and feel its truth in their hearts to join us in making these commitments real. Our words mean nothing without deeds. Therefore, we pledge and urge the following concrete actions:

- **Build Political Power in Our Communities:** Organize local assemblies, voter drives, and advocacy groups that represent Black interests unapologetically. ~~Run for office or support candidates who are accountable to the Black community.~~

[STRUCK 2026-09-11 - electoral candidate activity removed from this 501(c)(3)-hosted edition; parked for the affiliated 501(c)(4) sibling upon completion of its registration.]

- **Establish Independent Economic Structures:** Create and patronize Black-owned businesses, credit unions, and financial cooperatives. Form investment circles and cooperative enterprises to fund Black entrepreneurs and community development projects. Buy land to develop affordable housing, urban gardens, and community centers. Practice group economics - every time we spend a dollar, let it be a vote for Black self-sufficiency. Develop bartering networks and mutual aid funds so that our community can weather storms together. Each job we create and each dollar we circulate is a brick in the foundation of our economic independence.

- **Reclaim and Rebuild Our Culture:** Support Black artists, writers, and cultural workers who tell our stories with honesty and pride. Create Black-led schools, homeschooling networks, and after-school programs that teach true Black history and foster cultural pride. Mentor youth in traditional arts, languages, and wisdom passed down from our ancestors. Protect Black mental health and self-esteem by confronting racist narratives in media and replacing them with images of Black excellence and normalcy. Hold community festivals, readings, and workshops to celebrate our heritage (music, dance, cuisine, spirituality) in inclusive ways that welcome all Black people. Let a new Harlem Renaissance blossom in every city and every digital space where we gather.
- **Practice Collective Self-Defense and Community Care:** Form community patrols or peacekeeping teams to monitor and prevent police brutality and to mediate conflicts within our neighborhoods before they escalate. Train ourselves in legal literacy, first aid, and emergency response so we can protect and heal one another in times of crisis. Support Black legal defense funds and know-your-rights initiatives to empower our people against injustice. Simultaneously, invest in healing justice - build community gardens, wellness circles, and trauma counseling resources that help us recover from the wounds of oppression. Protect the community, and care for the community with equal fervor.
- **Strengthen Global Black Networks:** Connect with Black movements and organizations across the diaspora and on the African continent. Engage in people-to-people diplomacy: correspond, exchange visits, share resources and knowledge with our brothers and sisters abroad. Support Pan-African initiatives in education, technology, and environmental justice that benefit Black communities globally. Stand in solidarity against racism, whether it manifests as Afrophobia, xenophobia, or genocidal violence, anywhere in the world. By linking our struggles, we multiply our strength. We are not minorities; we are part of a global majority. Act like it - think globally while we build locally.

- **Join the Aboveground Railroad of Self-Determination:** Actively participate in the BLACK Dragons network or similar liberation organizations. Turn every Black institution - be it a church, fraternity/sorority, social club, or business - into a station on this Aboveground Railroad. This means coordinating efforts, sharing information, and offering sanctuary and support to Black people in need. If a family is struggling, the Railroad will rally resources to help. If a person faces political persecution for standing up, the Railroad will mobilize legal and community support. Just as the Underground Railroad was a lifeline to those escaping slavery, this Aboveground Railroad will openly guide and carry our people toward economic freedom, educational achievement, and political empowerment. Become a conductor on this railroad by volunteering, organizing, and spreading the word of this manifesto. Each of us has a role to play in this journey to freedom.

Each of these actions is a step on the road to our collective emancipation. We undertake them with a sense of urgency, for as W.E.B. Du Bois admonished, "Now is the accepted time, not tomorrow, not some more convenient season... It is today that our best work can be done." The seed-time of freedom is now. We cannot afford to defer the dream any longer; we owe it to our children and to our ancestors to move forward boldly.

Conclusion

In conclusion, we reaffirm that the BLACK Dragons are the living continuation of a long journey - we are the Moses generation and the Joshua generation combined, tasked both with leading and with building anew. We carry with us the spiritual memory of Exodus and the Underground Railroad, and we transform that heritage into a tangible movement for the 21st century: an Aboveground Railroad of hope and self-determination. Our manifesto is both an ode to the past and a map to the future. We seek to embody the highest aspirations of our forebears. In doing so, we heed Cornel West's enduring reminder that "justice is what love looks like in public." Our fight for justice is rooted in profound love - love for our people, love for our culture, love for our shared humanity. It is this revolutionary love that gives us the courage to demand what is rightfully ours.

Standing on the shoulders of giants and hand in hand with each other, we declare ourselves sovereign. We assert that Black people everywhere are deserving and capable of freedom, power, and peace. No longer will we ask for permission to exist freely - we take it as our birthright. Our Declaration of Self-Determination is a living document; its true power will be in its practice. Let this manifesto ring out in our speeches, our classrooms, our kitchens, our places of worship, and our halls of power. Let it be read and sung, critiqued and expanded, but most of all, implemented.

We call upon the spirit of ubuntu - "I am because we are" - to remind us that our individual futures are bound together. Each of us, a Black Dragon, carries within a spark of the divine and the ancestral; together, we form a mighty blaze that can light the path to liberation for all. Today, we pledge ourselves to this mission. We will organize, we will build, we will create, and we will rise. With faith in God and faith in ourselves, with ancestral guidance and contemporary urgency, we step forward. Oppression and despair are behind us; before us lies the rising sun of freedom.

In the name of all who came before and all who will follow, we hereby proclaim this Declaration of Self-Determination of the BLACK Dragons. May it guide our work and ignite our hearts. The journey continues - and we shall win. Power to the people! Black Power, Black Love, Black Liberation - Now and Forever.